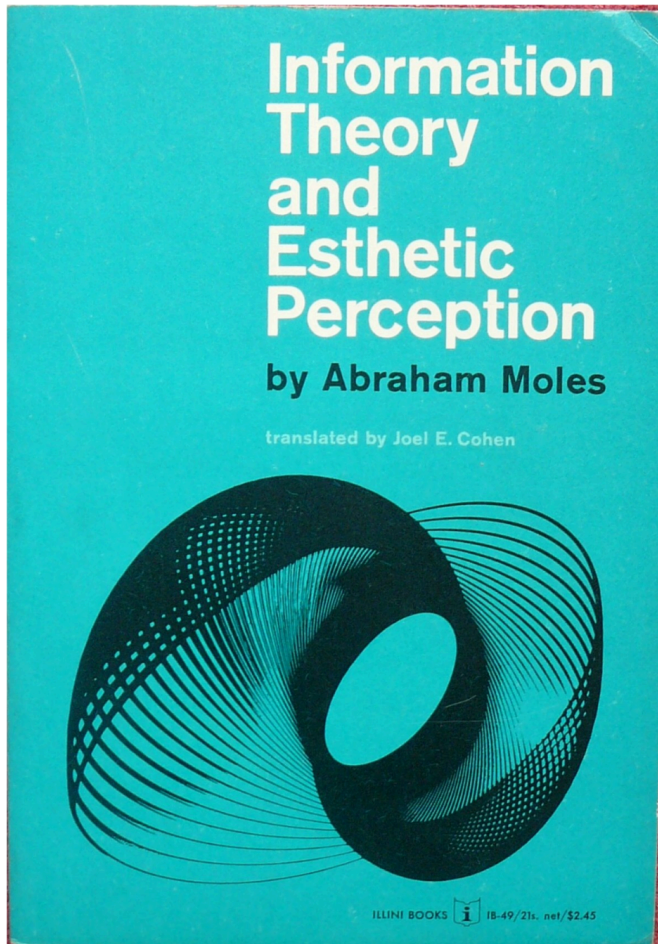


Information Theory and Aesthetic Perception by Abraham Moles and J. E. Cohen

Review by: Gordon Pask¹

This book, originally published in France in 1958, is a pioneering work that is likely to become a classic in this field. In it, Professor Moles outlines a point of view about aesthetics, a proposed experimental programme and a number of more limited, areas in which fruitful experiments have already been carried out. The main exemplars stem from the art of music, but the book should be read by anybody concerned with a cybernetic approach to the arts; by practising artists, who are anxious to analyse their work in these terms; and certainly by composers (especially, perhaps, those engaged in the synthesis of electronic music). To a significant but lesser extent, it is of interest to perceptual psychologists. The book is lucid and, on the whole, non-technical (where technical jargon is introduced, it is preceded by adequate descriptive passages).



Information Theory and Aesthetic Perception. Abraham Moles, (Trans. from French by J. E. Cohen) Univ. of Illinois Press, Urbana, 1965. 215 pp., \$7.50.

¹ Pask, G. (1968). Review of Information Theory and Aesthetic Perception by A. Moles & J. E. Cohen. Leonardo, 1(2), 205-206. The MIT Press.